



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Ref:	075	Author:	D Bibby	Date:	17.05.2024
Topic:			Hand-Arm Vibration		

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

What is Hand-Arm Vibration at work?

- Hand Arm Vibration Syndrome (referred to as HAVS) is caused by the over exposure to vibration in the hands, fingers, wrists and arms.
- HAVS is a disabling condition which could affect your ability to work and enjoy a normal home and social life.
- The good news is that HAVS is preventable. Early detection and reporting of symptoms are crucial. If these symptoms are ignored the disease can become much more serious and may become permanent.

HAVS can come from the use of:

- Hand held power tools such as portable drills.
- Hand held equipment such as wacker plates.
- Or by holding materials being worked by hand fed machines such as a wood-chipper.

Symptoms

Some of the symptoms of HAVS are:

- Pins and needles.
- Loss of sense of touch.
- Difficulty in everyday tasks such as fastening buttons or shoelaces.
- Tips of your fingers going white, particularly in cold and wet conditions, and becoming red and
- Painful on recovery.

To prevent and minimise HAVS at work:

- Use the right tool for the job to minimise vibration.
- Try to avoid long periods of using equipment without a break - short bursts are better.
- Keep tools and machines in good working order.
- Teams must rotate equipment and tasks throughout the day.

The purpose of the Control of Vibration at Work Regulations 2005 is to make sure that people do not suffer damage to their health from hand-arm vibration.

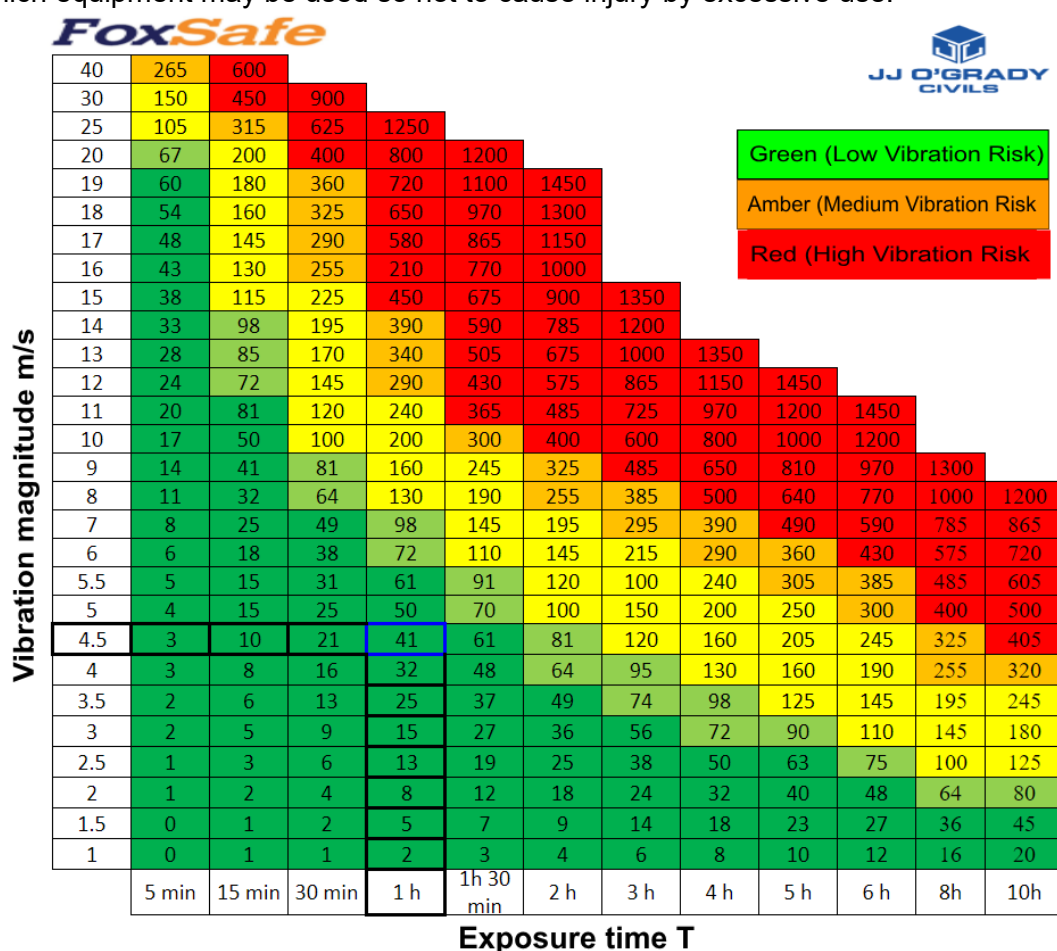
It is important for both you and us as your employer to record your usage of equipment and your length of exposure that could contribute to Hand Arm Vibration.

In order to do this, we are introducing an online HAV Usage Recording System, using a QR code (below).



Using the ready reckoner in the form

1. Find the vibration magnitude (level) for the tool or process (or the nearest value) on the white scale on the left of the table.
2. Find the exposure time (or the nearest value) on the white scale across the bottom of the table.
3. Find the value in the table that lines up with the magnitude and time. The illustration shows how it works for a magnitude of 4.5 m/s² and an exposure time of 1 hours: in this case the exposure corresponds to 41points (example below). This is placed in the HAVs points.
4. The colours on the HAVs ready reckoner, green, amber, red is to help indicate the vibration risk level at which equipment may be used so not to cause injury by excessive use.



Discussion Points

What tools do you use that cause hand arm vibration?

What would you do if you noticed that your fingers were tingling after you had finished a long job in which you used a Stihl Saw?